FOUNDING OVERVIEW | OCTOBER 2026

Agentic Runtime Trust

Working Group | ART

What must we know, declare and verify about an Agent for it to participate as a trusted operational actor?

What is ART?

ART is a new open technical working group focused on Runtime Trust for autonomous AI Agents. It addresses a specific problem: how an Agent's trusted operating state is declared, represented and continuously verified against real operational evidence as the Agent acts, collaborates and changes.

ART begins where many safety and security systems leave off. Policies, guardrails, permissions, identity controls, security findings and runtime constraints can establish important boundaries. ART asks how those boundaries are represented in the Agent's trusted operating contract, how evidence from multiple sources can verify whether the Agent remains within them, and how material change or Drift is handled.

POLICY / CONTROL	PASSPORT	RUNTIME EVIDENCE	ASSURANCE / DRIFT	GOVERNED CHANGE

External controls remain authoritative in their own systems. For example, a Passport may declare that an Agent must never access a protected share, while an IAM system enforces that restriction. Runtime Trust can preserve the relationship as a Control Binding and continue verifying evidence that the declared and externally enforced states remain aligned.

What we'll work on

PILLAR	ART WORK
DEFINE	Open standards and specifications, beginning with the Agent Passport Standard (APS).
TEST	ART Lab, running Agents, executable Personas and real Runtime Trust scenarios.
INTEGRATE	Connectors, reference implementations and interoperability with member technologies.
ADVANCE	Research, governance, professional practice and member-proposed areas.
COLLABORATE	Contribute Runtime Trust expertise to adjacent standards, protocols, research and industry initiatives.

Initial projects

Agent Passport Standard (APS) A portable, signed and versioned operational contract describing an Agent's approved trusted operating state - including identity, mission, authority, access, restrictions, collaboration, control relationships and provenance.

Personas & Scenarios A focused library of representative Agents and situations used to pressure-test the standards. Personas describe the Agent; Scenarios test what happens when authority, tools, collaborators, controls, evidence or operating conditions change.

Runtime Evidence & Reference Connectors Open reference integrations showing how evidence from Agent frameworks, observability systems, identity and access systems, security tools and other operational sources can be related to Passport claims.

ART Lab A shared environment where members can spin up Agents, create Passports, run scenarios, connect evidence sources, inspect runtime traces and test whether trusted operating state remains aligned. Harbor will be available as an initial Runtime Trust implementation for Lab work.

Interoperability & Contributions Mappings, profiles, reference implementations and contributions that make ART work with existing Agent, identity, security, observability, Web3 and enterprise standards rather than replacing them.

Why participate?

ART is intended to be a working technical community, not a mailing list. Members help shape emerging Runtime Trust standards while also making sure their own products, services, research and protocols can take advantage of them.

- ✓ Weekly video working sessions with technical updates, presentations, open issues, proposals and experiments.
- ✓ A real Slack community for collaboration between meetings, plus shared repositories and versioned artifacts.
- ✓ Access to ART Lab scenarios and the ability to bring member technologies into interoperability and Runtime Trust experiments.
- ✓ Opportunities to contribute standards, Connectors, Personas, Scenarios, reference implementations, papers and research questions.
- ✓ Collaboration with researchers and builders on publishable Runtime Trust experiments and findings.

A perpetual working process

ART is not working toward a single 'final' specification. APS, Connectors, Personas, Scenarios, interoperability profiles and research will all be versioned and continuously improved. Milestones represent demonstrated capability: real Agents can be represented; runtime evidence can verify Passport claims; independent systems interoperate; Runtime Trust works across Agents and organizations; and stable versions become dependable enough for production adoption.

Founding ART

Founder / Original Author: Tom Lindeman - 5thnode

ART is being formed now. Founding participants will help shape its priorities, workstreams, Lab experiments and technical direction. 5thnode is the initial convener; ART standards remain open and implementation-neutral.

FOUNDING MEMBERS / CONTRIBUTORS	FOUNDING ORGANIZATIONS
Add confirmed founding participants here.	*Add confirmed founding participants here.*